



CONTROLLED BECOMING

THE CONSTRUCTED SELF

SHAPING THE SELF:

between control, surrender
and the construction of identity.

By

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AW 2027

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PROJECTION

Growth has never been completely free for me. My family became the first structure that shaped the direction of my growth. Their expectations, rules and protection taught me discipline, responsibility and self-control. Like a clip supporting a growing plant, these boundaries restrict movement while also providing stability. What controls me can also protect me; what limits me can also help me grow. Over time, external control gradually becomes internalised.

I no longer need someone else to tell me how I should behave — I begin to control and discipline myself. This makes me question the boundary between support and restriction. Am I growing into who I want to become, or into who I have learned I should become? Controlled Growth represents this contradiction: being protected and restricted, shaped and supported, while still trying to find my own direction.

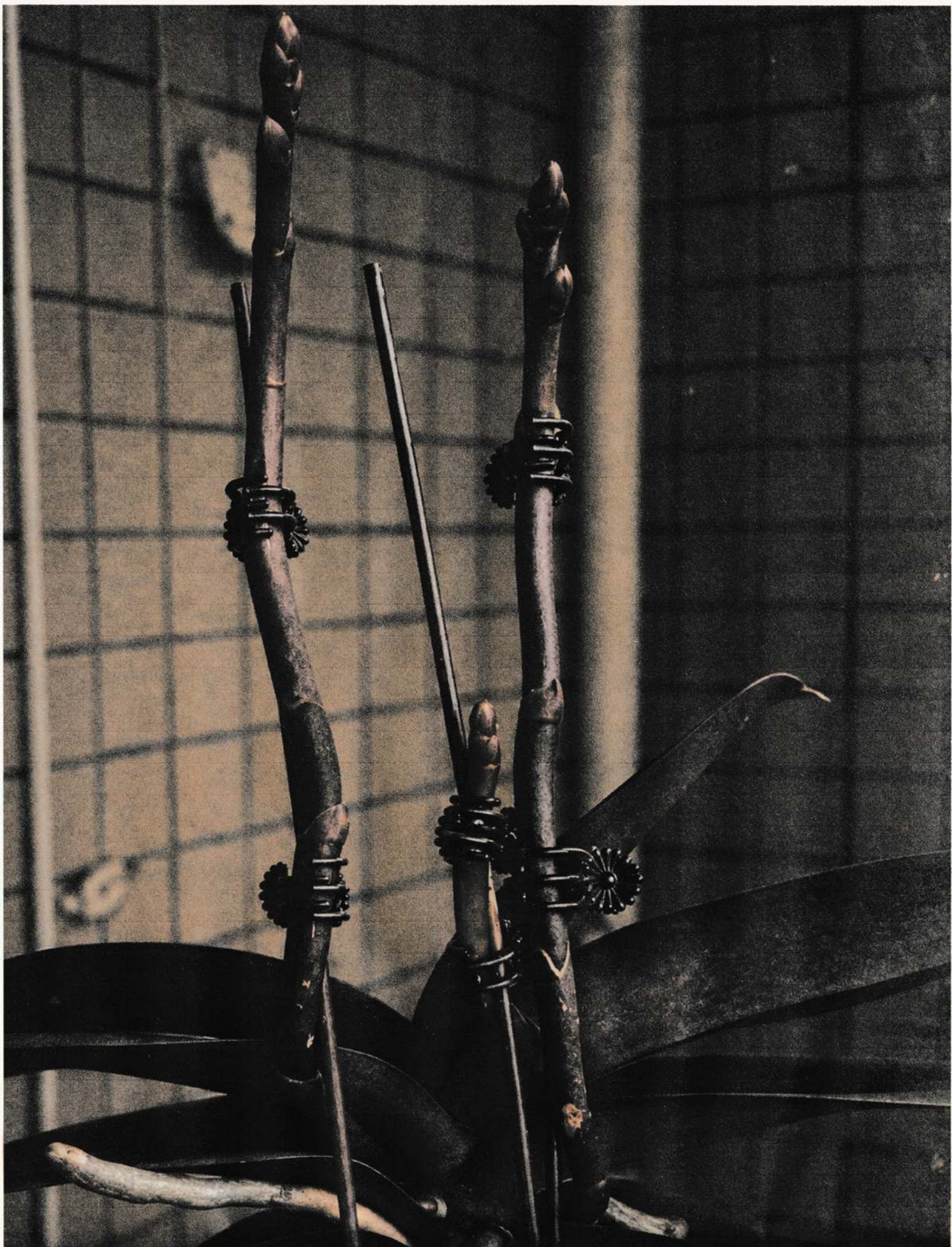


Figure:Cheng xian 2026.second Version of Triptych[Photo]

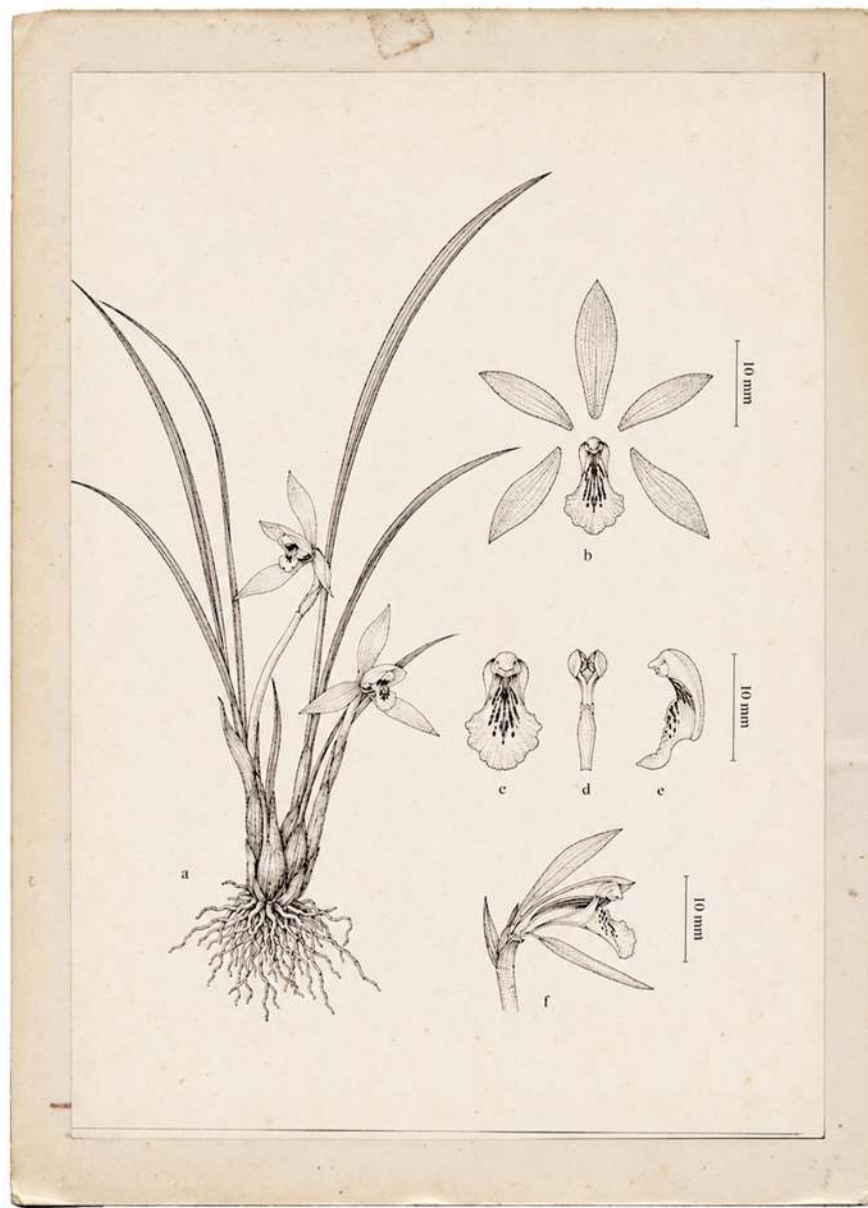
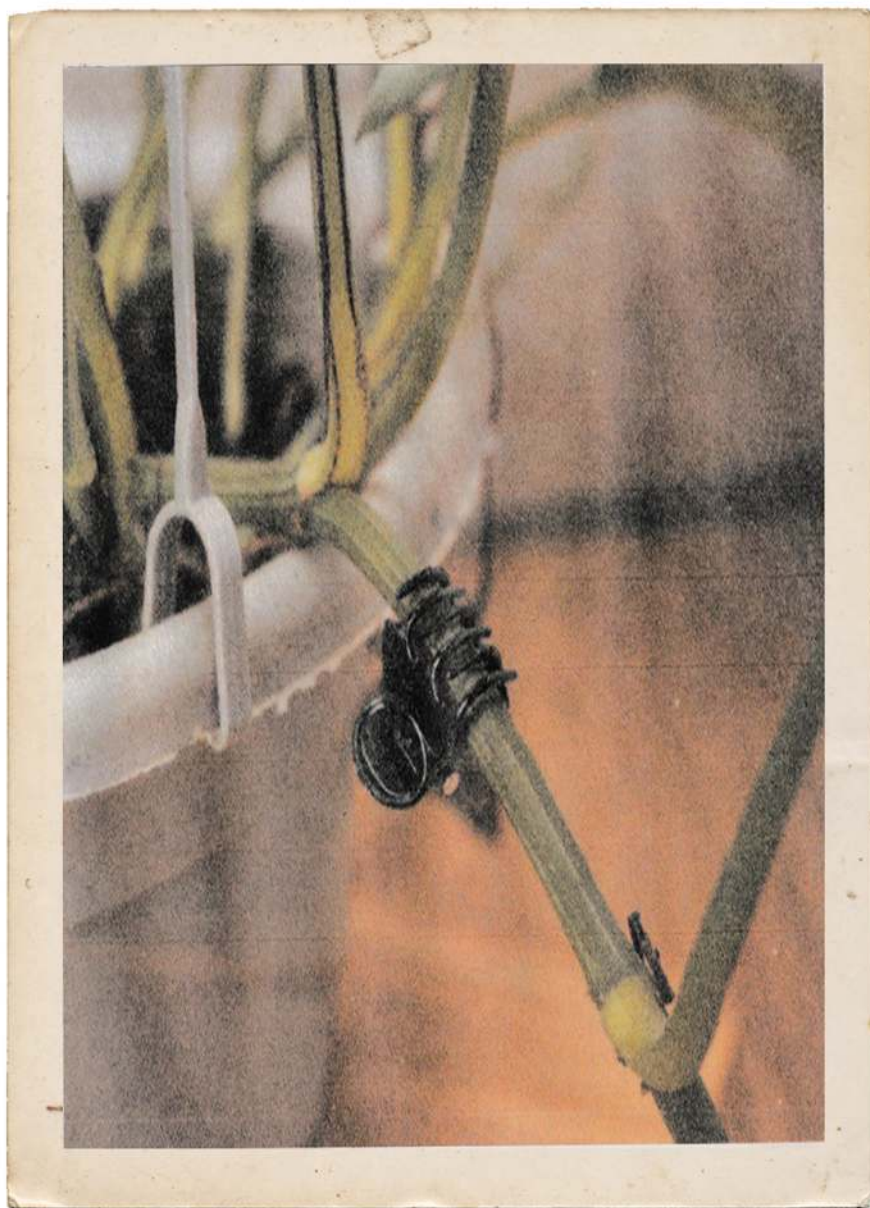


Figure:Cheng xian 2026.second Version of Triptych[Photo]



PART ONE PROJECTION FEEDBACK

HOW OTHERS READ ME

The image I construct does not end with me. It is read, interpreted and returned to me through others.

Many people initially perceive me as hard, intimidating and emotionally distant. Their perception becomes a form of feedback — a mirror through which I begin to see my own constructed image.



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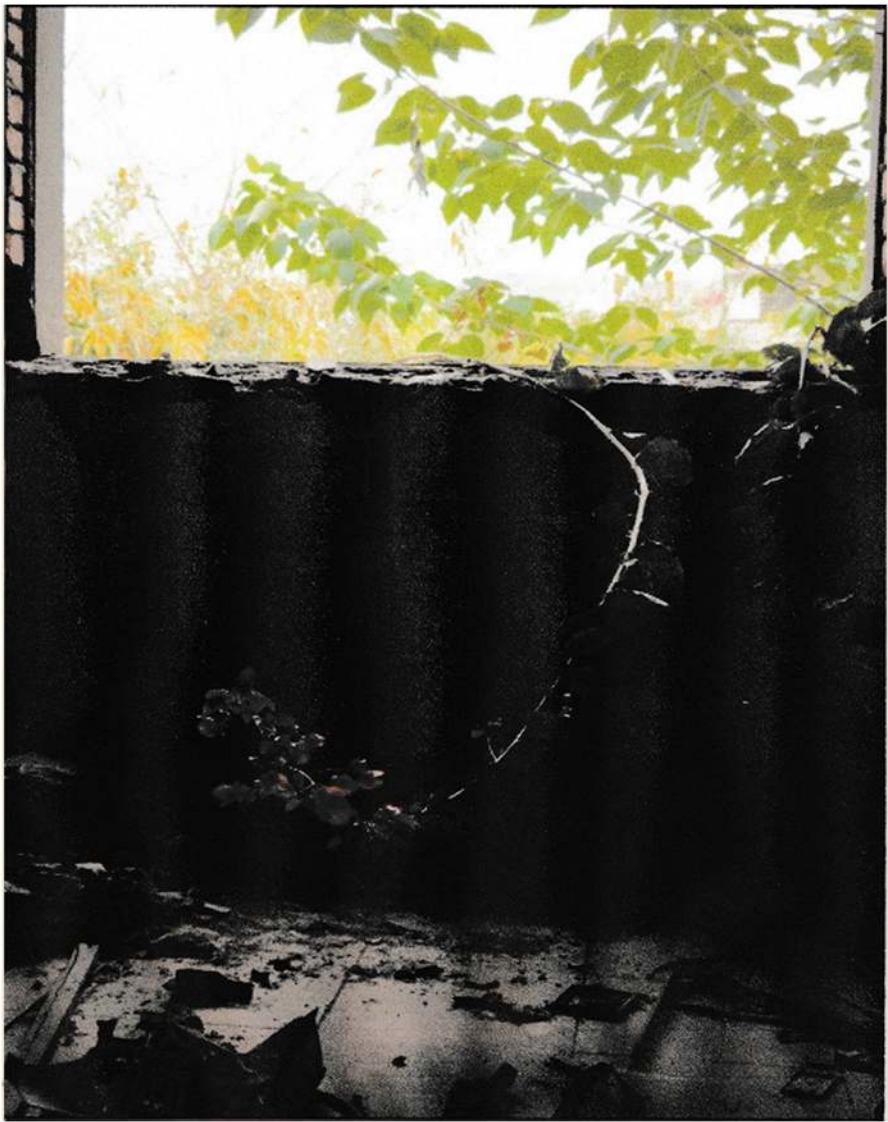
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CONTROL / SURRENDER

Leaving one system of control does not mean entering complete freedom..

At home, I am shaped by expectation, familiar rules and the gaze of others. Abroad, control returns through language, distance, adaption and the pressure to belong.



BETWEEN MOVEMENT AND CONTAINMENT

The suitcase becomes both a vehicle and a container: it carries the body forward, yet keeps part of it compressed and hidden.

Surrender is not escape or defeat. It is recognising these limits and allowing a more vulnerable self to exist within them.





Figure: Lee Seung-taek 《분신 행위 불》
可译作 Self-Burning Performance / Fire
1988-1989

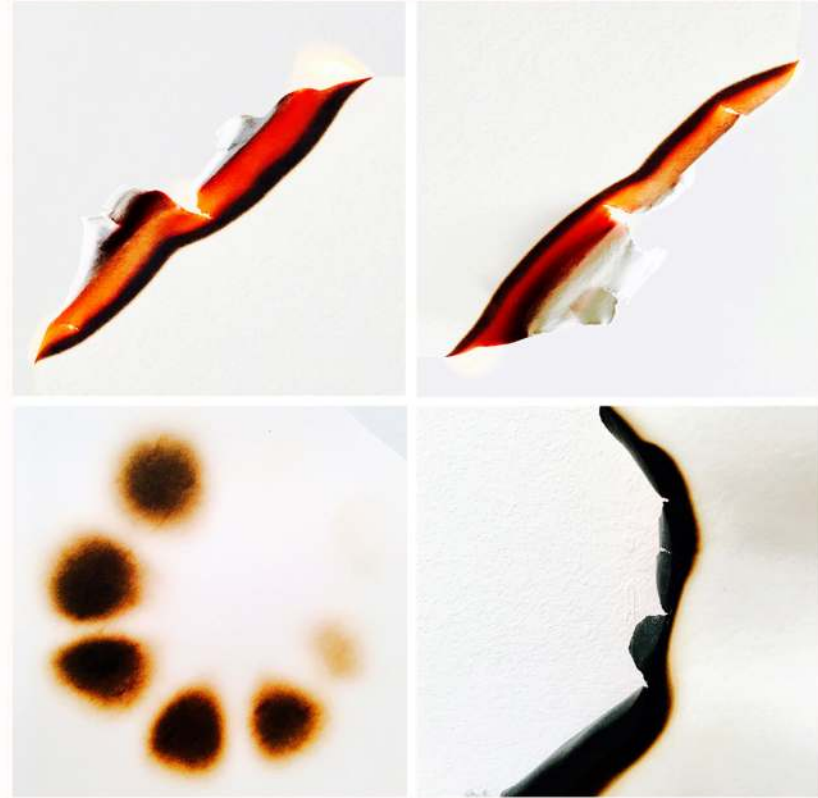


Figure: Opera Chocolates, 1994 Painted and chromium-plated steel
122.9 × 134.6 × 105.4 cm
Photo: Galerie Karsten GrevePhotoj

CONTROLLED GROWTH

Projection → Pressure → Feedback → New Form

Throughout my growth, I have been shaped by rules, expectations and control. Like material under pressure, I was not simply broken; I was folded into another form. What was projected onto me left traces that became feedback. Those traces did not return me to who I was—they participated in forming who I am now. I was supported. I was controlled. I grew through both.



THE CONTROL WITHIN

The outside voice gradually became my own.

I once believed that control came from outside — from family, society, expectations, and the gaze of others. But over time, those external forces became internalised. Their voices gradually became my own. Even when no one was watching, I continued to monitor, correct, and restrain myself.



Figure: Mona Hatoum, Performance Still, 1985/1995. second Version of Triptych [Photo]

The controller disappears, but the restraint continues within.

The controller no longer needed to be present, because I had learned to reproduce the control within myself. What I thought was external pressure had become self-discipline; what I thought was restriction had become a habit. Eventually, I realised that I was no longer simply being controlled — I had become my own controller.



Figure:Cheng xian 2026.second Version of Triptych[Photo]

BODY ECHOES

THE BODY BEYOND ITS OUTLINE

The body is never a fixed silhouette. In movement, it is fragmented, repeated and extended into space. The layered figure records tension, balance and physical effort, while the lines translate invisible trajectories into visible traces.

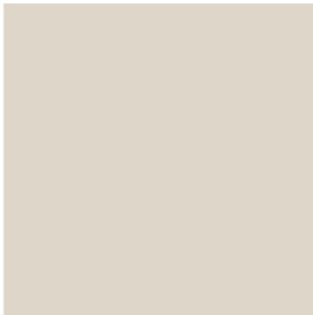
COLOUR



PANTONE 19-4008
TCX #272321



PANTONE 19-1250
TCX#8A4030



PANTONE 16-1305
TCX#A59D93



PANTONE 15-6310
TCX#A4AC94



PANTONE 19-1718
TCX#532C3B



PANTONE 19-5025
TCX#243F44



PANTONE 14-6007
TCX#B7C6B9



PANTONE 19-1245
TCX #803E2A



PANTONE 14-4522
TCX#5BC4E4



PANTONE 12-4306
TCX



Figure:Hella Gerlach inside-out #2 (textus conjunctivus), 2024
Wool, aluminum, spring steel, rubber cord
Variable dimensions

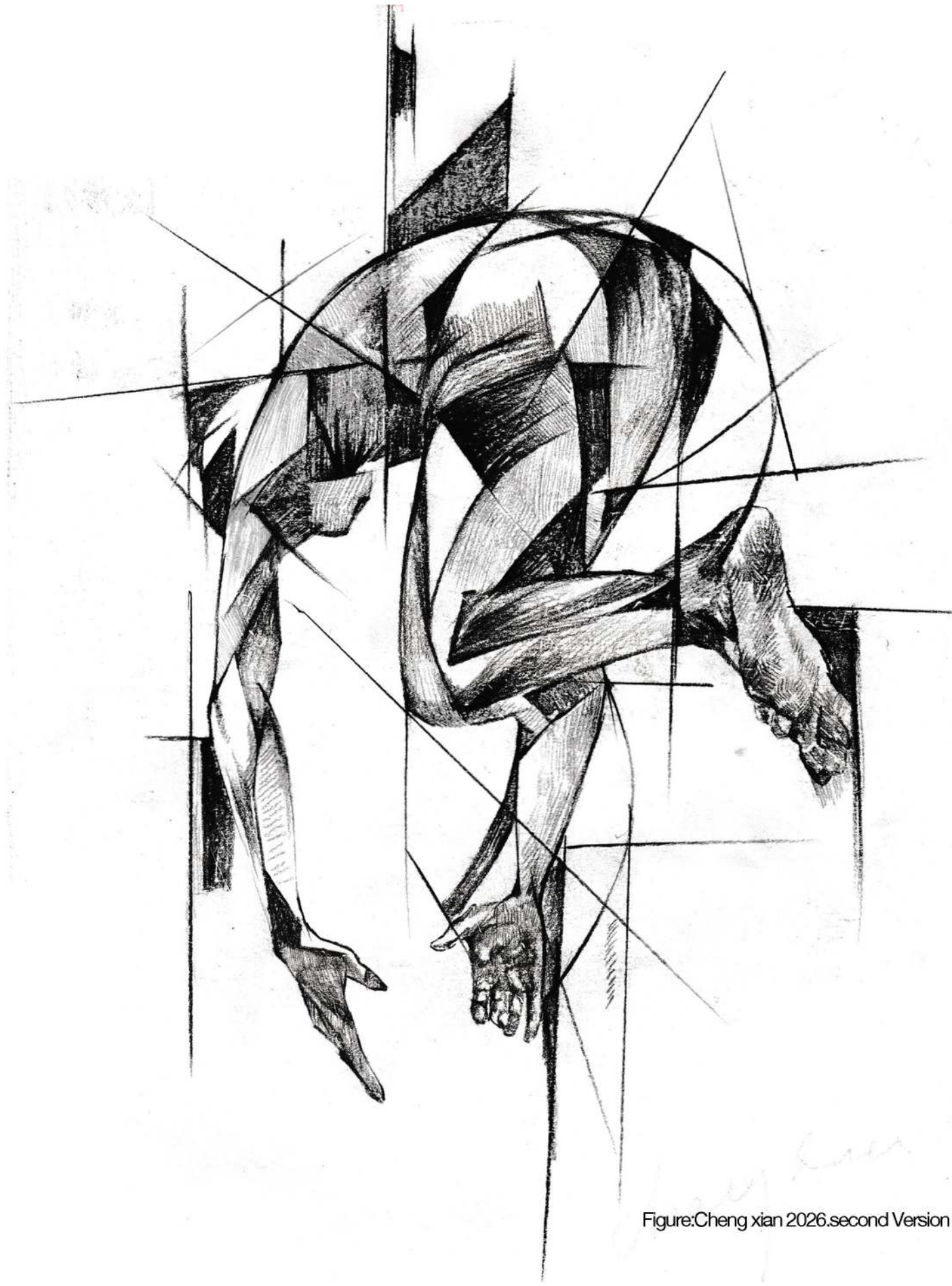


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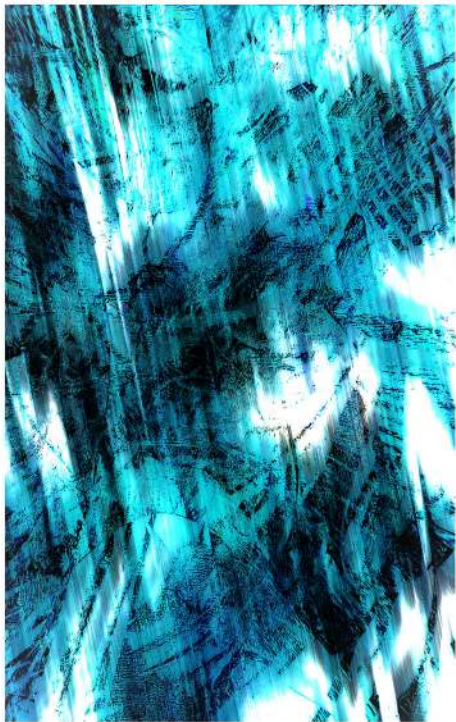
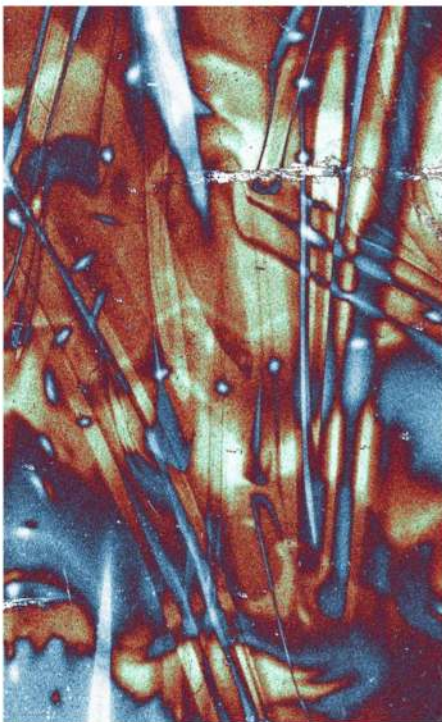


Figure:Umberto Boccioni, States of Mind III: Those Who Stay, 1911. Oil on canvas, 70.8 × 95.9 cm. The Museum of Modern Art, New York.

I
LOVE
ALL
PEOPLE

